

Chapter 55-5

//

Shallow Bay.

Xu Qingzhu was sitting on the living room sofa watching TV—a rare moment of rest for her.

Hearing the door, Xu Qingzhu looked over and met Liang Shi's gaze.

In that instant, she saw Liang Shi's reddened eyes.

Xu Qingzhu turned off the TV, placed the remote on the coffee table, and asked with a somewhat relaxed smile, "Teacher Liang, what grievance have you suffered?"

Liang Shi pressed her lips together and instinctively replied, "Nothing."

But when she answered, her voice was choked.

Even the ending tone was trembling.

Xu Qingzhu immediately frowned and stood up, walking toward her.

Meanwhile, Liang Shi placed the manila envelope at the entrance and bent down to change her shoes.

When she stood up again, her legs went weak and she almost fell. Xu Qingzhu was quick to catch her, and then Liang Shi's body weight leaned entirely on Xu Qingzhu.

Seeing her abnormal state, Xu Qingzhu softened her voice and asked, "What happened?"

"Let me recover for a moment," Liang Shi tried to speak normally.

"Take your time," Xu Qingzhu comforted her. "No rush."

She helped Liang Shi to the sofa, where Liang Shi curled up in the corner like a ball—a very defensive posture.

Xu Qingzhu poured her a glass of honey water and gently coaxed, "Drink a little."

Liang Shi's fingers were trembling as she took the glass—she had to use both hands to hold it steady.

She took several gulps, water droplets falling to the corners of her lips, which she didn't even think to wipe away.

Xu Qingzhu asked, "Did you drive home in this state?"

Liang Shi closed her eyes, "I drove very slowly. Can you wait for me to recover?"

"Of course," Xu Qingzhu placed the glass aside and quietly waited for her emotions to settle.

In front of Gina, Liang Shi didn't dare show any abnormality.

She was afraid Gina would see through her vulnerability and establish a doctor-patient relationship with her again.

On the drive home, she was also afraid of having an accident, so she forced herself to concentrate on watching the road.

It wasn't until now, after returning home, that her taut nerves finally relaxed.

Her head was buried between her knees, her whole being appearing fragile.

Xu Qingzhu sat beside her watching, then noticed the manila envelope by her side and asked softly, "May I look?"

Liang Shi's body swayed slightly, and she muffled a response: "Mm."

Xu Qingzhu opened the manila envelope, which contained detailed records of Liang Shi's psychological therapy sessions from when she was 18.

Very detailed question-and-answer sessions.

The first couple of sessions weren't particularly special—Liang Shi's responses to all questions were simple and crude.

Either "I don't want to talk" or "None of your business."

The doctor's diagnosis at the end was: Bipolar disorder with severe defensive mechanisms.

It was from the third session that Liang Shi opened her heart and began saying incoherent things.

[I have no childhood memories. I don't remember how I came to be here, but my family is very wealthy.]

[I really like this family, but my mother doesn't like me.]

[It doesn't matter, I don't need her to like me, but she says she loves me very much, and everyone says she loves me.]

[I have endless money to spend, and I believed my mother liked me.]

[I got seriously ill, but that illness happened because my mother accidentally pushed me into the frozen sea, yet my mother said it was evil spirits.]

[I want to destroy this world, it's too dark.]

[I want to kill people, animals will do too.]

[Only blood can keep me clear-headed.]

[Later I discovered maybe I don't need blood, I found another way.]

[What way? Why should I tell you?]

[I don't want treatment anymore.]

[I'm not sick, I just like playing exciting games.]

[...]

In the third, fourth, and fifth therapy sessions, her words were all very chaotic.

But it was clear that her mental state was abnormal.

Xu Qingzhu quickly skimmed through these materials, then asked Liang Shi, "Did you experience these things or did she?"

Liang Shi's emotions had calmed down somewhat, and she shook her head: "I'm not sure."

It seemed like the residual memories in this body were reminding her of everything that had happened in the past.

Her empathic abilities originally would only make her feel heartache, but nowhere near to this extent.

Since returning here, her hands and feet had been shaking continuously.

So she felt it might be the original owner causing trouble.

Her soul was restless and agitated, and this body was becoming restless along with it.